He said, ‘You let Muẓaffar Mīrzā and me make the fort fast, let Badī’u’z-zamān Mīrzā and Ẕū’n-nūn Beg go into the mountains near Herī and gather in Sulṭān ‘Alī Arghūn from Sīstān and Zamīn-dāwar, Shāh Beg and Muqīm from Qandahār with all their armies, and let them collect also what there is of Nikdīrī and Hazāra force; this done, let them make a swift and telling move. The enemy would find it difficult to go into the mountains and could not come against the (Herī) fort because he would be afraid of the army outside.’

Babur has said that he found Muhammad Barandūq Barlās’ strategy very practical.

According to Babur, although Ẕū’n-nūn Arghūn was brave, he was a mean man. He had strength but was highly materialistic by nature. Babur has said that he was far from being businesslike or judicious. Rather he was a shallow a bit of a fool. When both younger and elder brothers became joint rulers in Herī, Badī’u’z-zamān Mīrzā became the chief authority in the presence of Ẕū’n-nūn Arghūn. And now he didn’t want Muhammad Barandūq Beg to remain inside the town of Herī town. Being a man with charm for materials he himself wanted to be there with Muhammad gone. As Babur has stated:[*]

> Is there a better sign of his shallow-pate and craze than that he degraded himself and became contemptible by accepting the lies and flattery of rogues and sycophants?

Babur gave the particulars as under:

> While he was so dominant and trusted in Herī, certain Shaikhs and Mullās went to him and said, ‘The Spheres are holding commerce with us; you are styled Hizabru´l-lāh (Lion of God); you will overcome the Aūzbeg.’ Believing these words, he put his bathing-cloth round his neck and gave thanks. It was through this he did not accept Muḥammad Barandūq Beg’s sensible counsel, did not strengthen the works (aīsh) of the fort, get ready fighting equipment, set scout or rearward to warn of the foe’s approach, or plan out such method of array that, should the foe appear, his men would fight with ready heart.

Shaybāni Khān Takes Hold of Herī

It was the month of Muharram of AD 1507 (May-June) when Shaybāni Khān passed through Murghāb towards Sīrkāī. The news reached the ears of the Mīrzās, upsetting them. They couldn’t act the way that they should have—they essentially failed to assemble the troops. Babur has written, ‘Dreamers, they moved through a dream!’

Ẕū’n-nūn Arghūn was glorified by flattery around him. In his foolishness, he went to Qarā-rabāṭ with hardly 150 men to face the massive giant army of half a